

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 5 2
♥ Q 10 5
♦ Q 7 6 2
♣ 7 4 3

♠ A Q 8
♥ A 7 6 2
♦ 8 5 4
♣ A Q 9

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 9 4
♥ J 9 3
♦ 10 9 3
♣ 8 5 2

♠ K 7 3
♥ K 8 4
♦ A K J
♣ K J 10 6

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

few losers to worry about.

Partner has a balanced hand with 15-17 points. You have a balanced hand with 18 points. Together that makes two balanced hands with 33-35 points.

So you bid 6NT.

South would play 6NT.

Click

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♠J.

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♠J.

Winners: ♠ 3 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 4 : Total = 11

It's nice to make Plans for slams because there are so

This one is definitely straightforward. You need to get one more winner. You can hope for a 3-3 ♥ split which would mean your fourth ♥ would become a winner, or you can hope that East has the ♦Q in which case a simple finesse will give you the winner. But instead of making it an either/or situation you can combine your chances.

Win the first trick in either hand and duck a ♥. Win the return and play your 4 ♣ winners (discarding a ♦ from your hand) followed by your other 2 ♠ winners. Then play ♦A, ♥K and ♥A. You will be in your hand with two cards - the ♥7 and the ♦8. If the ♥7 is good, cash it and win the last trick with dummy's ♦K. If the ♥7 is not a winner then finesse the ♦J.

Always be on the lookout for situations where there are two possible routes to success.

Here the ♦ finesse was one possibility, but by ducking a ♥ you could test the ♥ suit and still keep the ♦ finesse in reserve.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 5
 ♥ Q 9 6 2
 ♦ A 7 4
 ♣ Q J 6

♠ 8

♥ K 7 5 4

♦ 10 8 6

♣ K 10 9 5 2



♠ A K 10 9 6 4

♥ J 10 3

♦ 9 5 2

♣ A

♠ 7 3 2

♥ A 8

♦ K Q J 3

♣ 8 7 4 3

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

You open 1♠ and partner responds 2♥.

With only 14 points and a 6-card suit you rebid a minimum 2♠. Partner raises to 3♠.

Your bids show 13-15 points. Partner has decided to invite you to bid game with a maximum. Since you have 14 points it's not really clear whether you should accept the invitation. You decide to add a little for your singleton Ace and bid 4♠.

East plays 4♠. South leads the ♦K.

East plays 4♠. South leads the ♦K.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

The two fast losers in ♥s can't be helped, but maybe you can get rid of one of the ♦ losers.

Win the ♦A and play the ♣6 to your ♣A. Play ♠A, then a small ♠ to dummy's ♠J. Lead the ♣Q. If North covers, ruff and re-enter dummy with a trump so you can discard a ♦ loser on the ♣J. If North doesn't cover the ♣Q when you lead it, discard a ♦ immediately. As long as North holds the ♣K you can make the contract. This is called a Ruffing Finesse.

In some hands there is more than one way to make the contract.

But in this deal the ruffing finesse is the only Plan that works.